

Reading for Understanding and Meaning

1. Why do you think Amir's father took his son to the gym at the age of eight? Amir's father took him to the gym because he was a "hyper kid" who had "a lot of energy". His father likely wanted him to have a productive way to use that energy.

2. What attracted Amir to boxing when he was very young? Amir was attracted to the atmosphere of the boxing club, including the smells of sweat and leather, the sound of bags banging and bells ringing, and watching people fight. He also enjoyed the hard work, the physical exercise, and the "adrenaline rush" of being in the ring.

3. Explain in your own words the factors that kept Amir focused on his training. Several factors kept Amir focused:

- **Self-Discipline:** He created his own mental preparation and routine because his friends were busy with other sports like football or cricket.
- **Ambition:** He had a strong desire to be the best at everything he did.
- **Success and Support:** Winning competitions and receiving "lottery funding" provided the resources and motivation to continue.
- **Mentality:** He maintained a "winner's mentality" and remained 100 percent focused and unafraid.

4. In what way is boxing a 'thinking sport'? Boxing is a "thinking sport" because it involves:

- **Studying Opponents:** Boxers must watch videos of their opponents and themselves to learn from mistakes and plan for the next fight.
- **Strategy:** A fighter cannot rely on just one game plan; they must have several options in case the first one fails.
- **Mind Games:** The sport involves psychological battles and "so much thinking" during the match.

5. What does Amir find 'awesome'? Amir finds it "awesome" that English fans still support him and treat him like a hero, even when he is fighting against an English opponent.

6. Explain in your own words why Amir thinks that people like him. Amir believes people like him because he behaves like a "normal" person and is not "cocky or arrogant" despite his success.

7. Write down three of Amir's ambitions. Amir's ambitions include:

1. Becoming a **world champion**.
2. Becoming a **legend** in his sport.
3. Being a **role model** for kids and helping them get into gyms.

8. Explain in your own words what Amir thinks is a 'force for good'. Amir believes that using boxing as a tool to take dozens of children off the streets and keep them out of trouble is a "force for good".

9. Explain the message which Amir gives to young people in schools. How successful do you think his school visits are? Give your reasons.

- **The Message:** Amir tells students to "walk on the right path," stay away from drugs and the police, and improve their lives through education or sport.
- **Success:** His visits appear to be very successful because he notes that "since I came back from the Olympics, the gyms are full," which shows that kids are following his advice and taking up the sport.

10. What are your impressions of Amir as a person and a sportsman from reading this interview? From the interview, Amir comes across as a very **dedicated and disciplined** athlete who is willing to work harder than others to transform himself from a "fat kid" into a "muscular" champion. As a person, he seems **humble and community-minded**, as he values respect and wants to use his fame to help younger generations stay out of trouble.